CHAPTER 2

MEASUREMENTS

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Learning Objectives:

- To understand the position of decimal point in the conversion of smaller unit to larger unit and vice versa.
- To do the four fundamental operations on quantities of different units.
- To read time in a clock and convert the 12 hour format to the 24 hour format and vice versa.
- To find duration between 2 given time instances.
- To do conversion of units of time.

2.1 Introduction

Let us listen to the following conversation between a teacher and a student:

Teacher: Have you ever noticed your mother buying knotted flowers? How is it measured?

Student: Yes teacher. The flower seller measures the string of flowers using her/his hand. She/He measures in cubit (*முழம்* in tamil).

Teacher: If you measure the same using your hand, what would you observe?

Student: It would measure more than one cubit,because my hand is shorter.

Teacher: Yes, how far is your house from the school?



Student: Just 100 feet, teacher.

Teacher: How do you buy rice, milk, cloth from the shop?

Student: We buy the rice in kilogram, milk in litre , cloth in metre.

Teacher: How much time do you spend on your homework?

Student: I usually spend an hour to do my homework.

Teacher: How do you measure height and weight?

Student: Height in centimetre, Weight in kilogram.

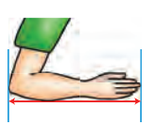
Teacher: Have you heard about any other measures used in earlier days?

Student: My grandparents talk of measures used in their days such as Padi (*படி*), Uzhakku (*உழக்கு*), Aazhakku (*ஆழாக்கு*), Marakkal (*மரக்கால்*), Feet (*அடி*), Span (*சாண்*), Cubit (*முழம்*).


Uzhaku


Padi


Marakkal


Cubit


Hand span


Foot


Balance

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